

# Context and quotes

DNS over Avian Carriers (DoAC)

DNS OVER AVIAN CARRIERS (DOAC) · DRAFT-CRUZGONZALEZ-IPOAC-DNS · IETF

## 1. APRIL 1ST RFCs — HISTORICAL CONTEXT

|                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| What an RFC is           | An RFC (Request for Comments) is the technical document that defines how the internet works: from how email is delivered to how a browser negotiates a secure connection. They are published by the IETF (Internet Engineering Task Force), the international body responsible for standardizing internet protocols.                                                             |
| The tradition            | Since 1978, the IETF has published humorous technical documents every April 1st. They are no less rigorous than any other RFC: they follow the same format, use the standard normative language (MUST, SHOULD, MAY), and are permanently archived in the IETF database. The difference is that their stated purpose is humorous — their technical execution is entirely serious. |
| RFC 1149 (1990)          | "A Standard for the Transmission of IP Datagrams on Avian Carriers" — the foundational document of the avian-carrier saga. It specifies how to transmit internet packets using homing pigeons. Published April 1, 1990, by D. Waitzman.                                                                                                                                          |
| The 2001 implementation  | In April 2001, the Bergen Linux User Group (BLUG) in Norway implemented RFC 1149 with real pigeons. They sent 9 packets; 4 arrived. Packet loss: 55%. Average round-trip time: ~3,000 seconds (~50 minutes). The experiment was considered a success.                                                                                                                            |
| The avian-carrier saga   | RFC 2549 (1999) added Quality of Service to avian-carrier infrastructure. RFC 6214 (2011) extended support to IPv6. DoAC (2026) closes the last remaining gap: domain name resolution. The avian-carrier protocol stack is, for the first time, complete.                                                                                                                        |
| Other notable April RFCs | RFC 2324 (1998): Hyper Text Coffee Pot Control Protocol (HTCPCP) — a protocol for controlling coffee pots over the internet. RFC 3514 (2003): The Evil Bit — proposes adding a bit to IPv4 packets to indicate malicious intent. RFC 5514 (2009): IPv6 over Social Networks.                                                                                                     |

## 2. QUOTES FROM THE AUTHOR

*The following quotes may be used directly by members of the press, attributed to Christian Elías Cruz González.*

### ON THE ORIGIN OF THE DOCUMENT

"I came across RFC 1149 in university and found it the most absurd and brilliant thing I'd ever seen. When I discovered that in 2001 a group of Norwegians had actually implemented it — with real pigeons, packet loss and all — I understood that this was something serious dressed as a joke. The avian-carrier protocol stack had been incomplete for decades. Someone had to close the DNS gap."

### ON THE IANA CONSIDERATIONS SECTION

"The IANA Considerations section is my favorite. The IETF is used to receiving requests for registries of all kinds. I came in with a long list, and then wrote that I required no action on their part. It's a very specific joke for those who know the process: technically impeccable, internally absurd."

### ON THE AAA RECORD

"There's a detail in the document that I find very amusing: I'm reserving the "AAA" record type for future use without defining what it is. If the document is lucky, in a few years someone will have to write an RFC explaining what on earth AAA means in the avian context. That's exactly the kind of ordered chaos that characterizes this tradition."

### ON THE DRAFT'S ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

"The document's acknowledgements include a pigeon. Not a metaphorical one — a specific one. It's the kind of detail that either nobody notices, or someone notices and finds very funny. I prefer writing for that second type of person."

### ON THE EDUCATIONAL VALUE OF HUMOROUS RFCs

"The avian-carrier saga does something few technical resources manage: it explains how the internet works using a medium anyone can physically imagine. When you read how a packet is transmitted on a pigeon's leg, concepts like latency, packet loss, and name resolution suddenly have real weight. I think these RFCs are a seriously underrated science communication tool."

## PRESS CONTACT

| AUTHOR                        | EMAIL                     | WEBSITE          | FULL DRAFT                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Christian Elías Cruz González | contacto@christianecg.com | christianecg.com | <a href="https://datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-cruzgonzalez-ipoac-dns/">datatracker.ietf.org/doc/draft-cruzgonzalez-ipoac-dns/</a> |